

The Picky Eater Progress Tracker

A Practical Guide to Measuring Food Acceptance & Building Healthy Habits

Measuring Success (Without Stress)

For a picky eater, success is not defined by eating a plate of salad on Day 1. Success is defined by *tolerance*, *curiosity*, and *micro-tastes*. If your child touches a piece of carrot, smells it, or lick-tests it, they are progressing!

Use this tracker to log your child's interaction with new foods. Do not force them to swallow; let them progress through the 5 Stages of Food Acceptance at their own pace.

The 5 Stages of Food Acceptance

1. **Tolerance:** The child allows the new food to sit on the table or on their plate without screaming or throwing tantrums.
 2. **Interaction:** The child touches the food, stirs it with a spoon, or helps you wash/prep it in the kitchen.
 3. **Smell:** The child willingly smells the food.
 4. **Touch to Lips/Tongue:** The child licks the food or holds it against their lips.
 5. **Taste & Swallow:** The child takes a bite, chews, and swallows it.
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Weekly Progress Log Sheet

Date	New Food Introduced	Safe Food Chained With	Stage Achieved (1-5)	Child's Reaction / Notes
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Example	Spinach (Palak)	Moong Dal Cheela	Stage 2 (Interaction)	Helped mix the green batter. Smelled it but didn't taste.

Rules of Engagement (The Parent Code)

Rule 1: Division of Responsibility

Your job: Decide **what** food to serve, **when** to serve it, and **where**.

Your child's job: Decide **whether** to eat it, and **how much** to eat.

Rule 2: The "One Bite" Rule

Always serve a micro-portion of the new food (e.g., one single green pea or half a slice of kiwi) alongside 2-3 of their favorite safe foods. Ask them to just lick or take one micro-bite. If they dislike it, they can politely spit it in a napkin.

Rule 3: No Emotional Reactions

If they eat it, do not throw a huge celebration (which makes them suspicious). If they refuse it, do not get angry or show disappointment. Keep mealtimes neutral and low-stress.

***KhaduFarm Quality Tip:** Engage picky eaters by taking them shopping or cooking with them. Let them touch fresh walnuts, smell dried apricots, or peel kiwis. Children are 80% more likely to taste a food they personally selected or helped prepare.*